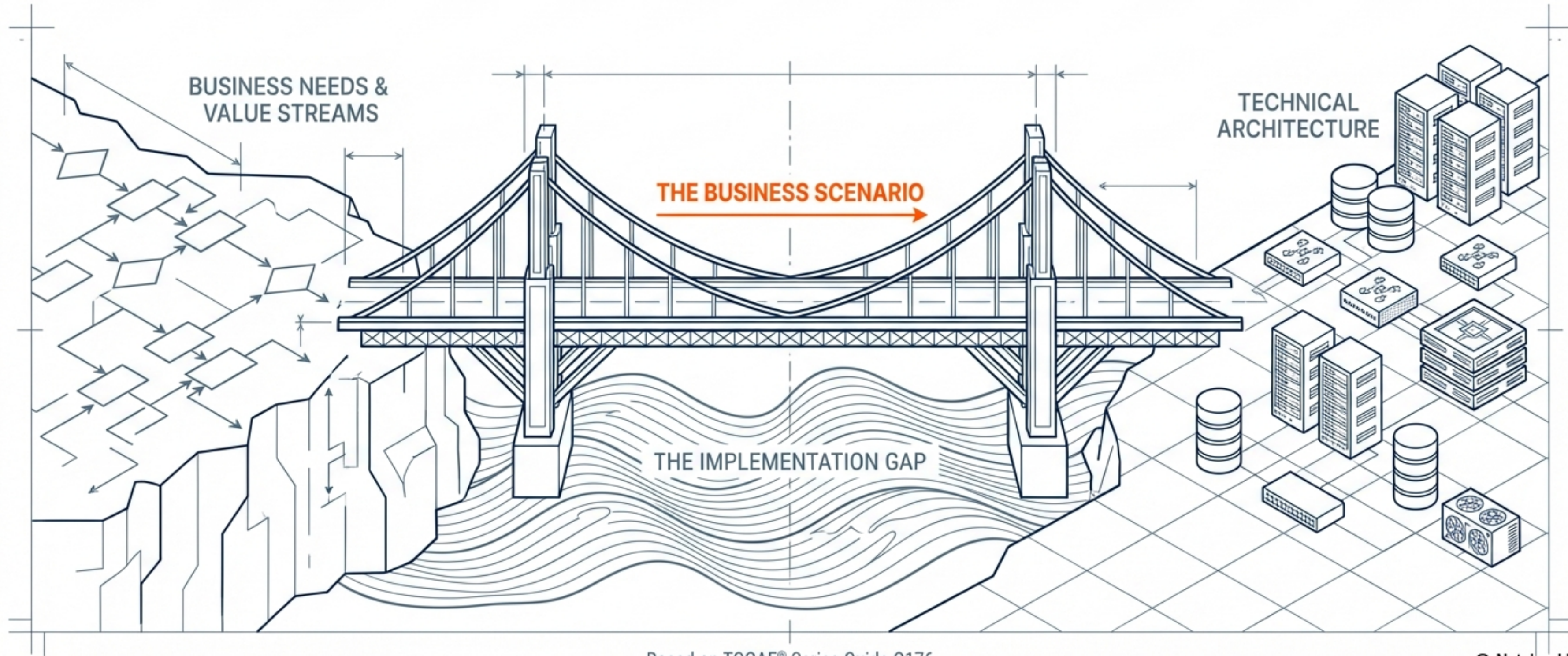


MASTERING BUSINESS SCENARIOS

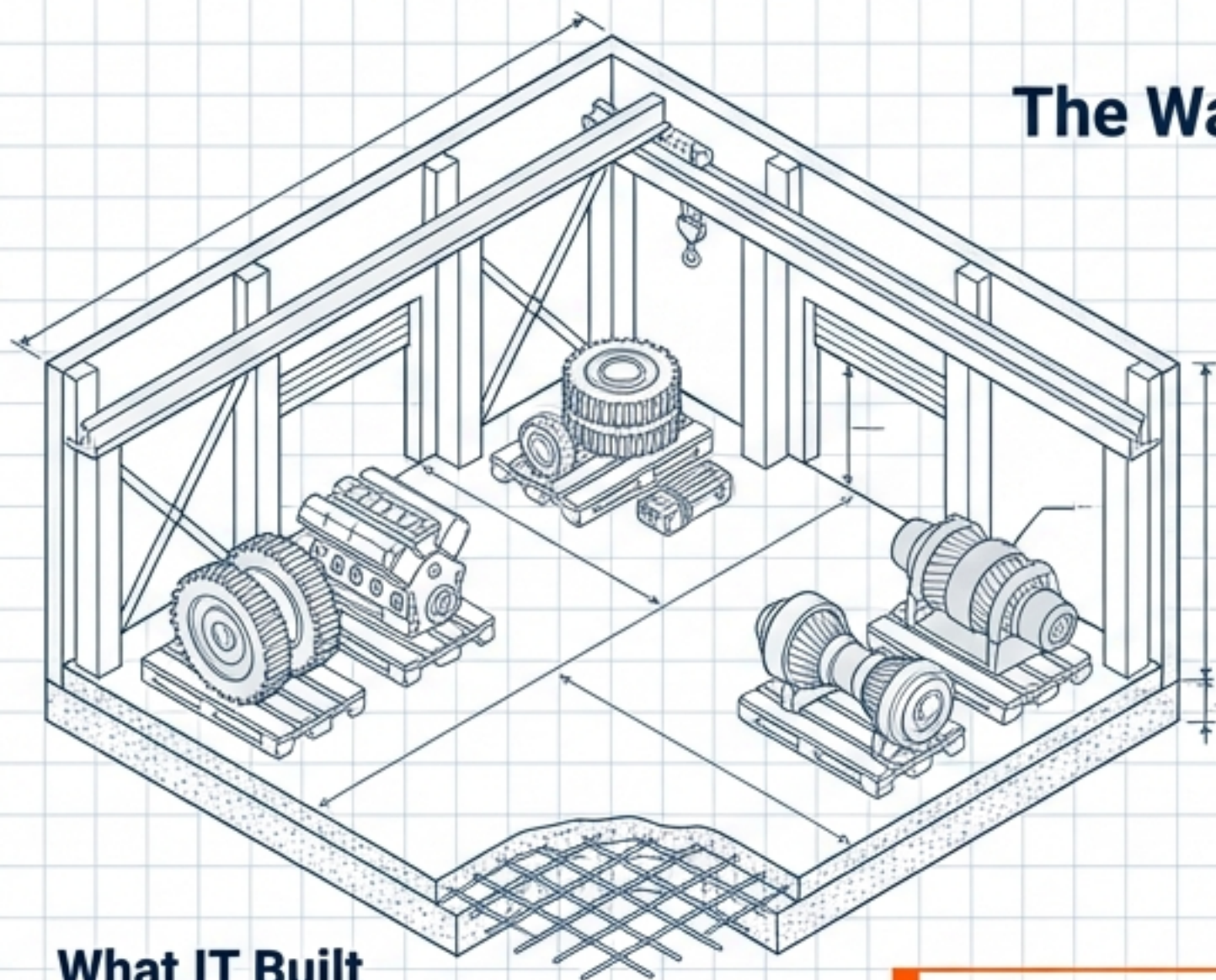
A TOGAF® Series Guide to Aligning IT Architecture with Business Value



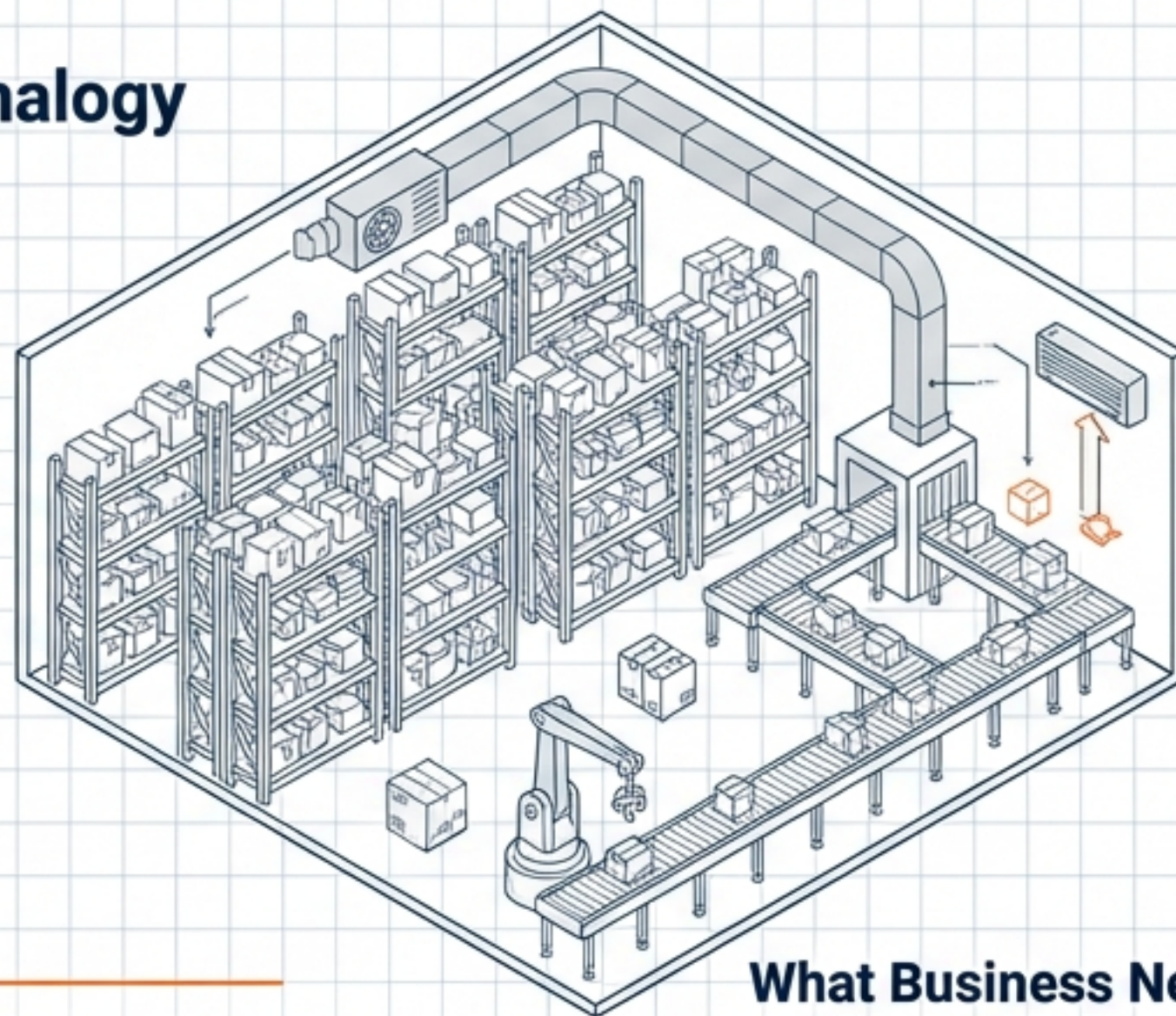
Architecture Without the “Why” Is Dangerous

Building a solution without a Business Scenario is like constructing a building without knowing its occupants.

The Warehouse Analogy



What IT Built
(Heavy Industry Spec)



What Business Needed
(Consumer Goods Spec)

Risks

- Risk 1: Incomplete solutions that miss the actual need.
- Risk 2: Wasted costs on redundant or unnecessary heavy-duty features.
- Risk 3: Mismatch between the IT solution and the business value stream.

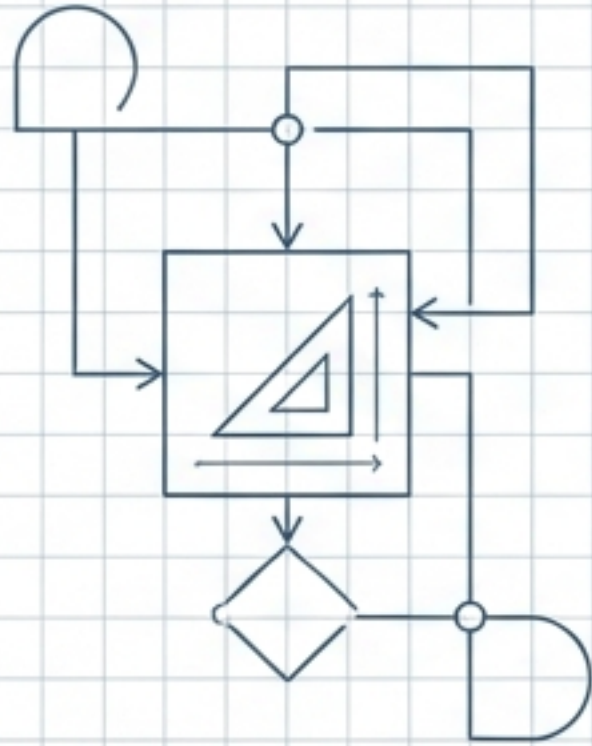
The Business Scenario Is a Uniform Description of Value

Building on the need for the “Why”, the Business Scenario acts as a precise, standardized definition of value.

The Definition

A mechanism to validate the premise behind an architecture effort. It must capture:

- ✓ Real business problems
- ✓ The business and technology environment
- ✓ Value streams enabled by capabilities
- ✓ Desired outcomes
- ✓ Human and computing actors

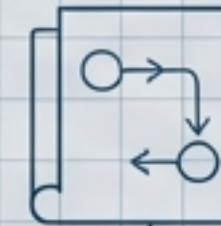


The Core Standard:

A Business Scenario must be **SMART** (Specific, Measurable, Actionable, Realistic, Time-bound).



Distinctions



NOT a Use Case

Use cases describe detailed software interactions.



NOT a Business Case

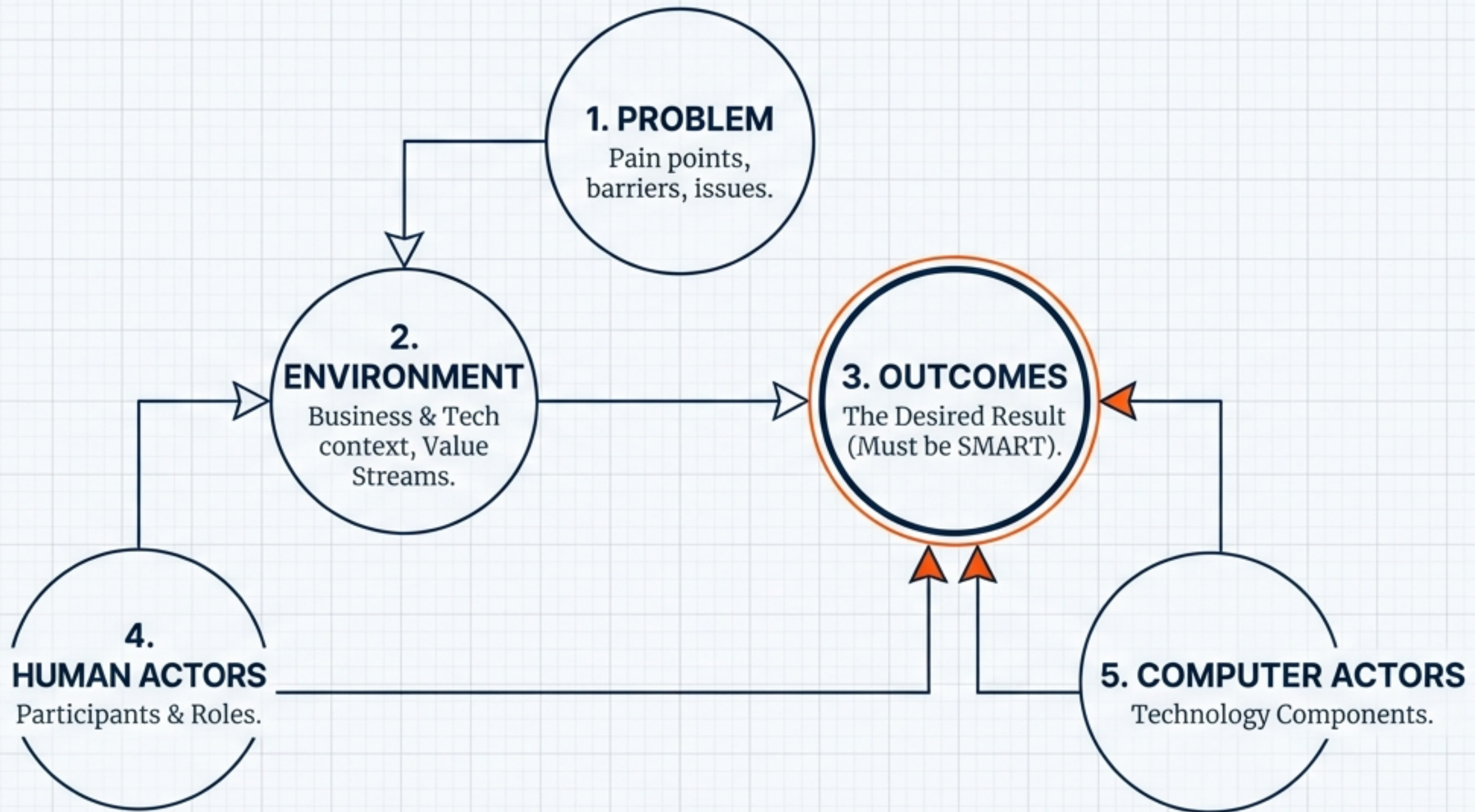
Business cases are for financial justification.



NOT a Specification

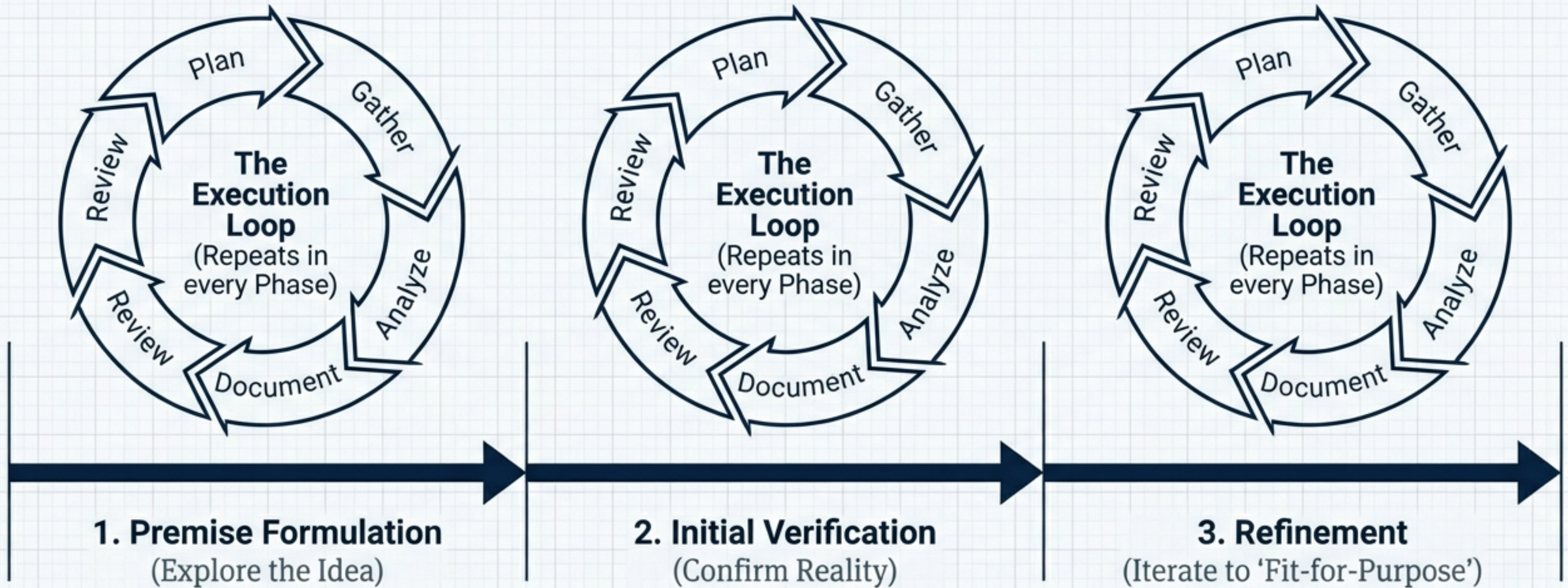
Specs are material-specific and tied to engineering science.

The Anatomy of a Business Scenario



The **Problem** exists in the **Environment**, necessitating Outcomes, which are achieved by Human and Computer Actors.

The Methodology: A Cycle of Refinement



Key Insight: The 5-step loop is repeated within each Phase. The output of the Review step determines if you move to the next Phase or iterate again.

Steps 1 & 2: Planning the Approach and Gathering Data

Step 1: Plan (The Mini-Project)

Treat scenario creation as a project in itself.

☐ → **Identify Participants**
(Buy-side vs Supply-side)

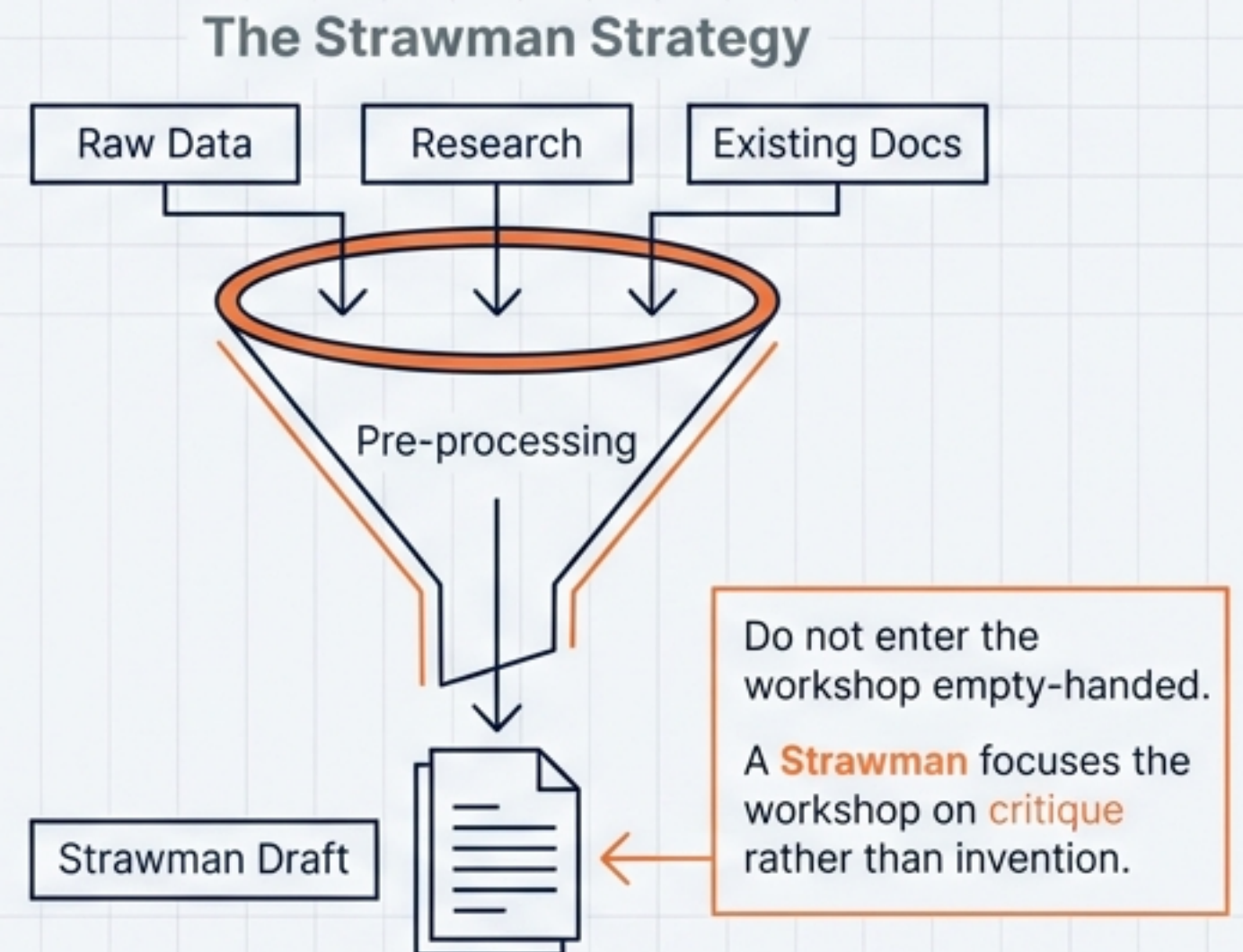
☐ → **Set Constraints**
(Time, People, Money)

☐ → **Identify the Sponsor**



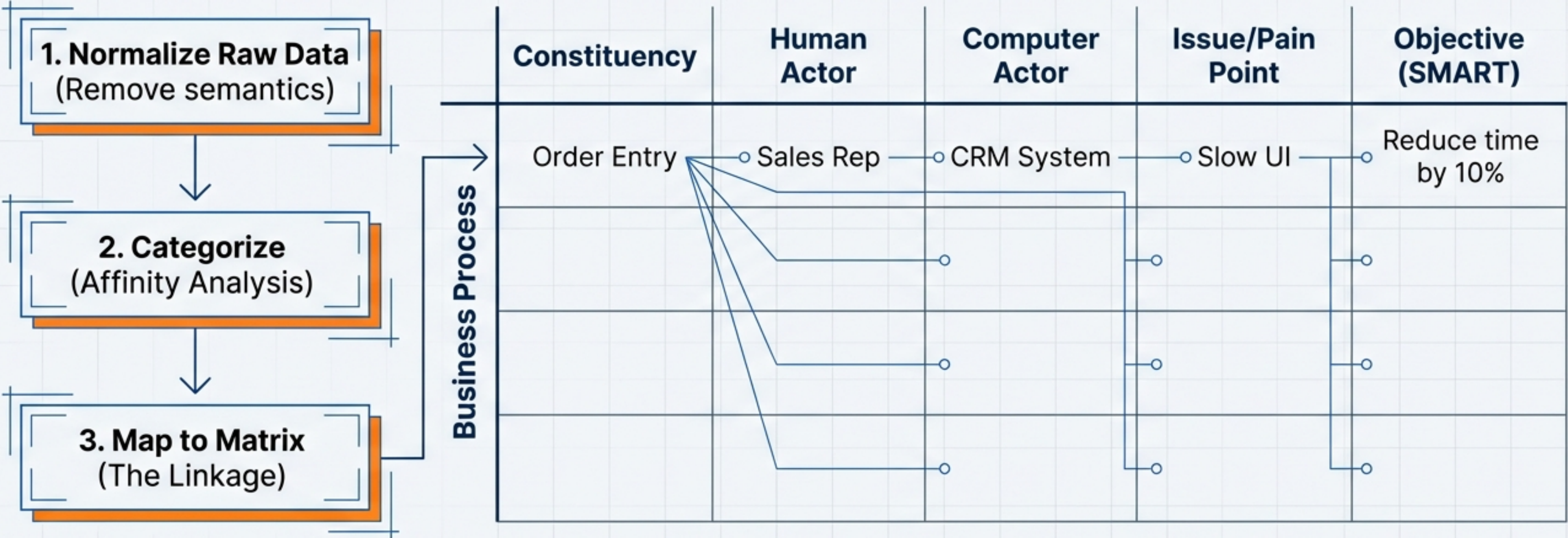
Step 2: Gather (The Raw Material)

Methods include research, surveys, and the Business Scenario Workshop.



Step 3: Analyzing—Where Data Becomes Insight

Creating a Uniform View via the Linkage Matrix



Goal: Every process must be tied to an actor, an issue, and a measurable objective.

Steps 4 & 5: Documenting and Reviewing



Step 4: Documenting

Create the Record of Reference.

Rule: Must be readable by business management, not just IT architects.

Body = Main Findings & Narrative

Appendices = Detailed Data, Metrics, Full Lists



Step 5: Reviewing

The Feedback Loop.

Mechanism: Readout meetings with sponsors.

Goal: Ensure shared understanding of scope and impact.

Outcome Box

Decision: Buy-in or Stop.

“The absence of shared expectations is in many cases the root cause of project failures.”

Navigating the Three Phases of Maturity

Phase 1: Premise Formulation

Input: An unstated question or vague directive (e.g., “We need an ERP”).

Action: Identify the “**Solution looking for a problem**”.

Output: List of key questions & stakeholders.

Phase 2: Initial Verification

Action: Face-to-face stakeholder engagement.

Goal: Confirm the problem is **real**.

Output: Draft Business Scenario (Verified but incomplete).

Phase 3: Refinement

Action: Iterative analysis.

Goal: Make it Fit-for-Purpose.

Output: Approved Business Scenario ready for Architecture Vision.

Vague Goals Lead to Vague Solutions

Transforming Objectives with the SMART Framework

S.M.A.R.T.
Specific - Measurable - Actionable - Realistic - Time-bound

The Vague Wish

Improve User Productivity.

A consistent user interface will ensure functions behave in a similar fashion.

Add
Measurement

Better

Reduce Errors.

This will lead to better efficiency and fewer errors.

Apply SMART
Criteria

The SMART Objective

By Q3 [Time], provide a consistent interface across devices [Actionable]... leading to 10% greater user efficiency and 20% fewer order entry errors [Measurable].

Where to Find Value: Categories of Goals



Process

- Increased throughput
- Consistent output quality
- Predictable costs



Cost

- Lower redundancy
- Reduced lifecycle costs
- Lower maintenance



Risk

- Security & Safety
- Regulatory Compliance
- Reduced human error



Operations

- Faster time-to-market
- Improved service quality



IT Effectiveness

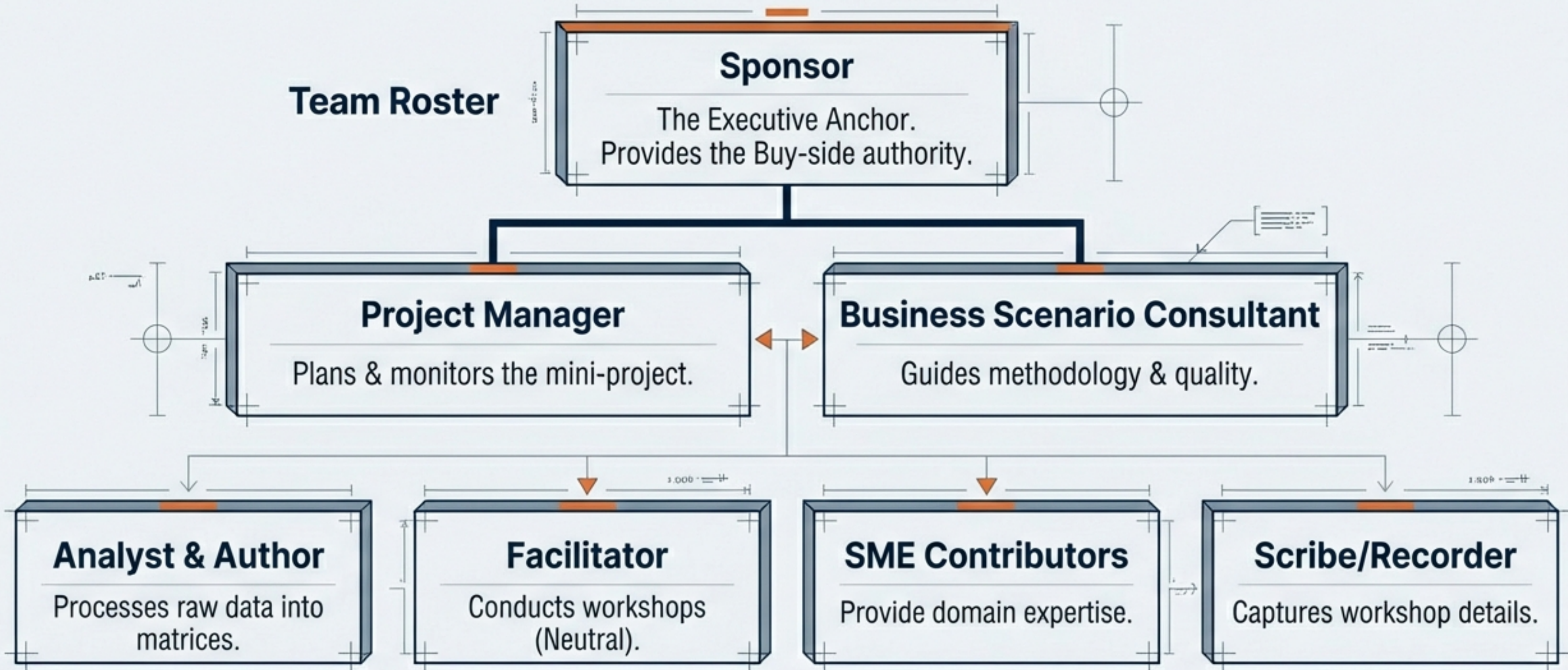
- Interoperability
- Vendor independence
- Portability & Resource sharing



User Experience

- Consistent interfaces
- Improved productivity

Roles & Responsibilities: The Scenario Team



The Workshop Toolkit: Techniques for Extraction

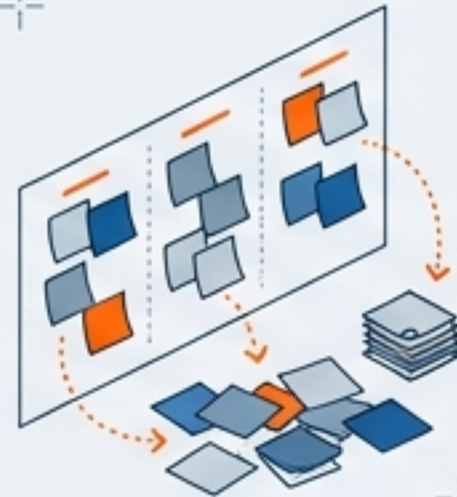
1. Active & Reflective Listening



Paraphrasing to confirm understanding.

Method: Mirroring & Clarification

2. Brainstorming with Affinity Analysis



Generating ideas and organizing chaos into groups.

Method: Idea Generation & Categorization

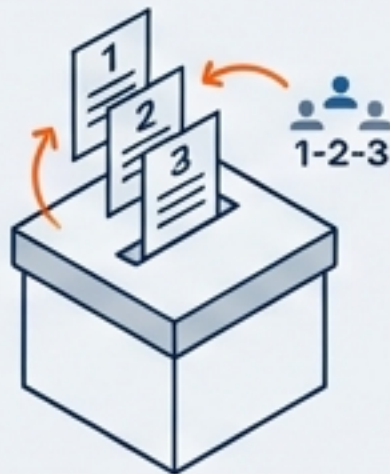
3. Money/Credit Voting



Give participants a budget of fake money to 'spend' on features they truly value.

Method: Resource Allocation & Prioritization

4. Multi-voting



Successive rounds to reduce a list to top 3-5 items.

Method: Consensus Building & Reduction

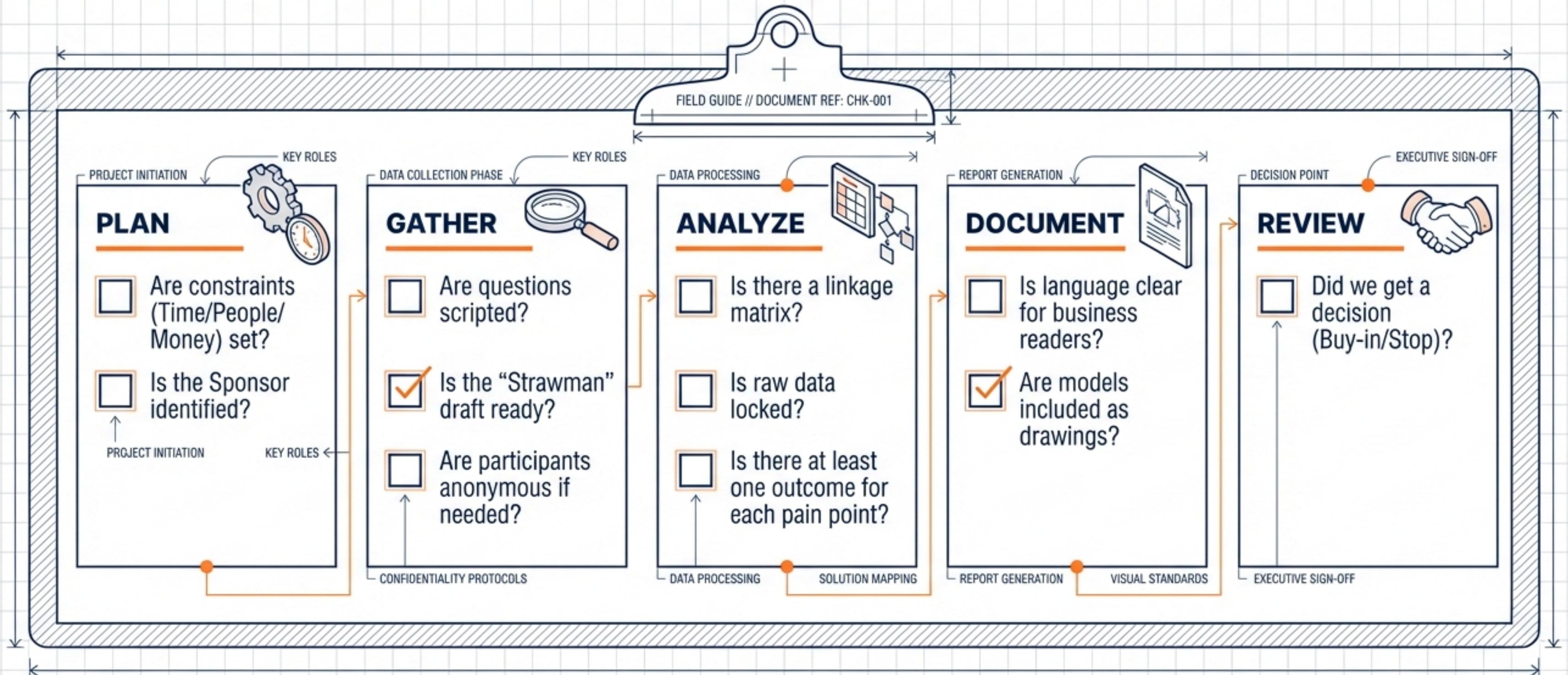
5. Role Play



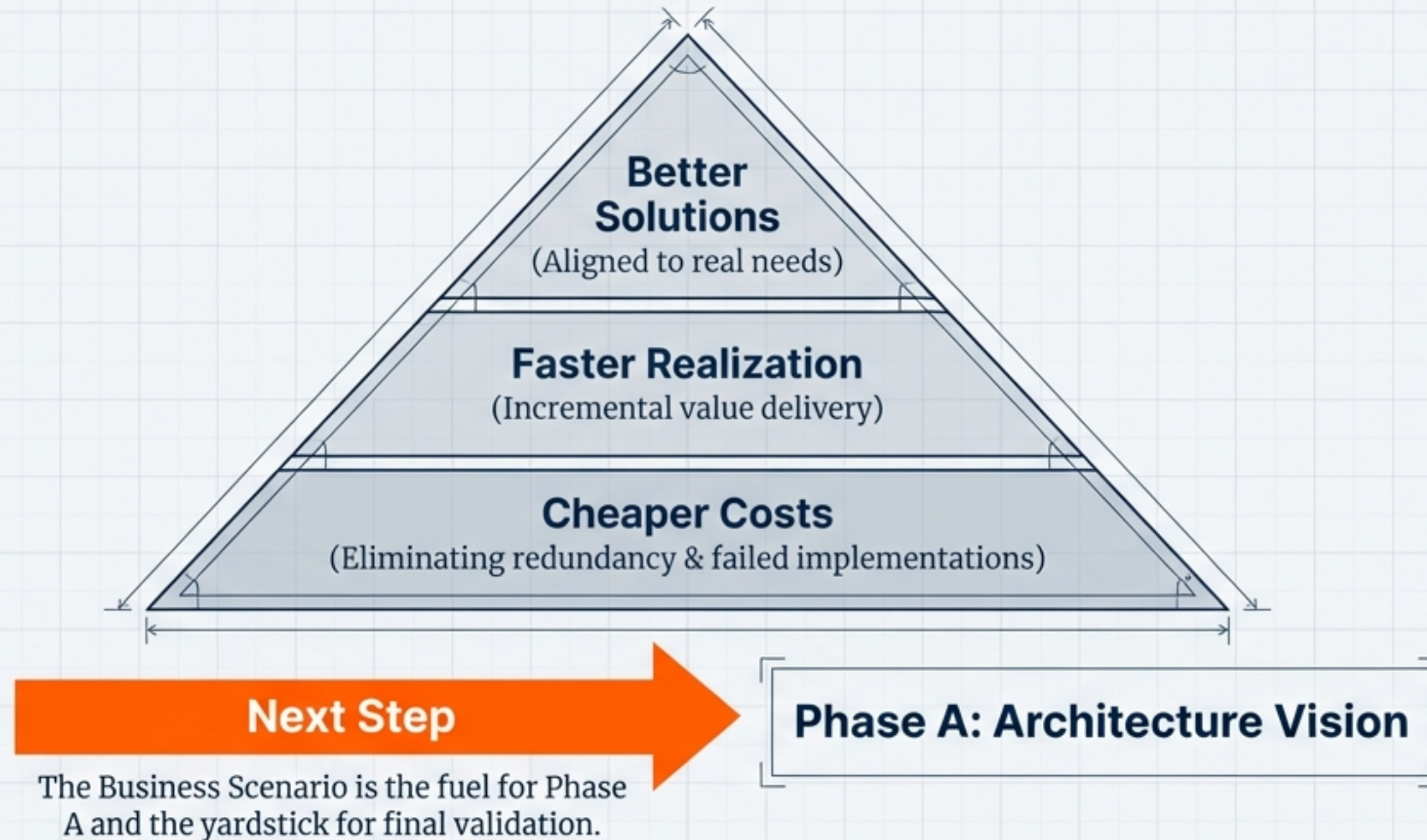
Understanding opposing viewpoints (e.g., Supplier plays Buyer).

Method: Empathy Mapping & Scenario Simulation

The Practitioner's Checklist



The Strategic Value of the Business Scenario



The end game is not the document; the end game is achieving the desired business outcome.